



SCHOOL OF EDUCATION

DEPARTMENT OF EARLY CHILDHOOD STUDIES

COURSE CODE: BEC1106

COURSE TITLE: GENERAL METHODS OF TEACHING ECD

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PURPOSE OF THE COURSE

This course will help the learner conceptualize Early Childhood Curriculum planning, development, organization, implementation and evaluation. It will give the learner the required knowledge, skills and attitudes in Pre-Primary school curriculum delivery.

COURSE DESCRIPTION

This course entails definition of terms and concepts used in curriculum planning, development, organization, implementation and evaluation; early childhood curriculum concept and rationale and framework for early childhood curriculum; preschool curriculum design and curriculum activity areas; early childhood curriculum development process; pre-primary school curriculum resource materials and records; highlight of methods of curriculum delivery and evaluation; role of caregiver in early childhood curriculum and challenges experienced.

TEACHING/LEARNING METHODOLOGIES

This course will be offered and/or undertaken through tutorials, group discussions, group and individual assignments, presentations, interactive questions and answers, micro-teaching lessons, peer teaching and e-learning interactive forums. The learner will be required to go through this training module, make notes based on the objectives of the course and attempt the questions given at the end of every lesson. Tutorial classes will be organized by the university where the lecturer will take the student through the course. The purpose of tutorials is to help the learner conceptualize the course. It is, therefore, important to study the module before attending the tutorials. Further reading in this area of curriculum is encouraged. However, all information gathered should be within the course description and objectives.

COURSE ASSESSMENT AND EVALUATION

Learning will be assessed through sit in Continuous Assessment Tests (CATs), Take Away Assignments and a Main Examination. The CATs will constitute 30% and the Examination 70%

MODULE ORGANIZATION

This module is organized in form of lessons. In every lesson an introduction is given. The introduction shows what the lesson constitutes. This is followed by the lesson objectives. Then, the learner is taken through the lesson content. The content may be sub-divided into sub-topics depending on the nature of the topic in a lesson. A summary of what has been learnt is given. At the end of the lesson the learner is given activities. These activities are in form of questions and/or practical. It is good to note that this is not a text book. The content is therefore in form of lecture notes. Further reading from text books is recommended. A list of books to refer to is given at end of the module.

COURSE CONTENT

- Educational goals and instructional objectives
- Definitions of instructional methods
- The need for effective teaching strategies and preparation
- Review of the general methods used in teaching young children.
- The need for timing and mediation.
- Teacher characteristics that promote learning.
- Individualizing learning
- Importance of technology and instructional media
- Classroom management and arrangement
- Maintaining class discipline
- Establishing interest centre in an ECD class
- Grouping children for learning

COURSE OBJECTIVES

- a) Define educational goals and instructional objectives
- b) Define instructional methods
- c) Explain the need for effective teaching strategies and preparation
- d) Describe the general methods used in teaching young children.
- e) Discuss the need for timing and mediation.
- f) Discuss teacher characteristics that promote learning.
- g) Explain the aspect of individualizing learning in ECDE
- h) Discuss the importance of technology and instructional media in ECDE
- i) Discuss the importance of classroom management and arrangement
- j) Explain ways of maintaining class discipline
- k) Describe the importance of establishing interest centre in an ECD class
- l) Explain the methods of grouping children for learning in ECD

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LESSON 1: EDUCATIONAL GOALS



Objectives

By the end of this LESSON the learner should be able to:

- a) Define relevant terms*
- b) Explain the importance of educational goals and instructional objectives*
- c) Describe important steps to follow when setting educational goals*
- d) Discuss the determinants of a country's educational goals*

Introduction

Goals are important in every situation of our lives. They help us have focused intentions to achieve intended outcomes. In the field of education, goals are necessary if intended results will be realized. They lay a foundation for the formulation of educational objectives. The dynamics of educational goals and objectives are the concern of this LESSON.

Definition of concepts

A goal is what one plans to achieve. Educational goals are those statements by individuals, educational institutions or whole countries that indicate the intentions to be achieved through the given educational system. National education goals help individuals to form personal education goals.

Determinants of a country's educational goals

- Cultural etiquette
- Politics
- Government policies
- Economic resources
- Environment
- Finances

- Social needs/social dynamics
- Emerging issues
- Gender
- Natural disaster(s)

Goals are necessary for arriving at previously chosen points the absence of which means failure to arrive at an intended destination e. g the goals of education in Kenya are to:

- Fosters National promotion and promote national unity
- Promote social economic technological and industrial needs for national development
- Promote individual development & self-fulfillment
- Promote sound morals and religious values
- Promote social equality and responsibility
- Promote respect for and development of Kenya's culture values
- Promote international consciousness and foster positive attitudes towards other nations
- Promote positive attitudes towards good & environmental protection.

For a Christian educator the following would be worthy goals

- To indoctrinate the students in truth
- To develop moral responsibility
- To develop a sense of rights in a student in relation to the surrounding world

1.1 SETTING EDUCATIONAL GOALS

Setting educational goals like any other goal is very easy to do. Sticking to those goals is the most difficult task that is, implementing the set goals. One needs to learn how to set goals that you can actually achieve and that which will complement your future.

Important steps to follow

Be specific: Don't generalize your educational goals. Example, instead of saying you want to graduate in University in 3 years say how you will graduate in 3 years. It makes it easier to follow steps and know where you should be at any given time in those 3 years.

Goals should be achievable: To take into account the time available for you and consider your other responsibilities when forming your goals. Example, bringing up a young family, handling 3 teenagers, looking after sick old parents and setting a goal to complete studies in 3 years would be unachievable but 4 years would work for you.

Goals should be realistic in nature: It would be unrealistic to say you want to be an accountant when you hate mathematics and science subjects or an engineer or a lawyer when you don't perform in language. Make sure your goals are in line with your capabilities and your willingness to walk an extra mile

Write your goals down: Keep them somewhere where you can see them often. Don't just keep them in your head because you can easily forget or change them often. Keep them in a visible place so that you are often reminded what you should be accomplishing. For example, on the wall across the bed, refrigerator or electric panels.

Tell someone else your goals: (your mentor or confidant). This person will always ride you're back asking you how far you are with your goals. You therefore feel compelled to complete them as planned.

Research your education goals before you set forth on your journey to accomplish them. For example, find out about the curriculum, the college status and viability of the course. Be sure of how the course will be useful to you but don't go for it because it's fashionable with other people or during the season.

1.2 INSTRUCTIONAL OBJECTIVES

An instructional objective is a statement / description that state how the instructor or teacher will use an instructional activity, instructional material or program to achieve the desired objective.

It is a statement showing specific measurable achievement that the instructor should achieve at the end of an instruction. They are also descriptions of what a learner is to do to demonstrate competence. For example, by the end of the lesson the learner should be able to name 5 external parts of the human body with 75% success. Performance outcome may describe different levels of what students may do to demonstrate the level of competence (75%) or how well they have conceptualized the ideas or skills of the lesson.

Instructional objectives may also be called “performance objectives, behavioral objectives or simply objectives”. Objectives are specific, achievable (outcome based), measurable and describe the learners’ behavior after discussion. **Specific** means they should describe precisely what the learner is expected to do, for example, ‘**name**’.

Achievable means the objective is going to state what the learner should be able to achieve at the end of the instruction, for example, ‘**external parts of the human body**’.

Measurable means the objective should describe the learning outcome that can be measured for example, (75%).

Instructional objectives are key to effective teaching/instruction. Effective instruction occurs only when students’ behavior (knowledge/attitude) is changed in desired ways. Because instructional objectives are tools for describing student’s outcomes they provide a means of making instruction effective. The language of instruction is language used in teaching in/within a learning institution.

1.3 IMPORTANCE OF INSTRUCTIONAL OBJECTIVES

- Make teaching effective because they allow for a measurable feed back
- Serve as a guide for student/ teachers on what to do and eliminate guess work since expectations are clearly defined.
- Guide selection of instruction media (teaching materials) and procedures or teaching methods to be used by facilitators.
- They determine the appropriate ways or methods to evaluate the learning. Evaluation is based on each instructional objective.

Instructional objectives may be classified according to the primary learning outcome that take place. These learning outcomes are classified into three domains/ categories:

1. Cognitive
2. Psychomotor
3. Affective

ACTIVITY

1. Discuss the importance of goals in an education system.
2. Which important steps should one follow when setting educational goals?

LESSON 2: EFFECTIVE TEACHING STRATEGIES/ METHODS



Objectives

By the end of this LESSON the learner should be able to:

- a) Define the terms teaching, learning and pedagogy*
- b) Describe various teaching/learning strategies used in ECDE*
- c) Discuss five elements of effective classroom teaching.*

Introduction

This LESSON discusses effective methods of teaching that a pre-school teacher can use to impart knowledge. A teacher should consider the learners' background, environment and the learning goals to select a reliable method. The latter include Question and answer, explaining, demonstrating, experiment, educational visits, dramatization, role-play, Collaboration and Singing.

A strategy is a deliberate planning and organization of an experience and situation with a view to achieving specific goals (Nasibi, 2003). In ECDE, it is defined as a way and means of organizing and facilitating learning experiences. Thus, ECDE applies two teaching/learning strategies namely, expository (transmission) and heuristic (discovery) will be discussed under learning and teaching approaches.

2.1 TEACHING STRATEGIES

Appropriate teaching strategies/ methods can best be articulated by defining learning or the purpose of learning /education. Learning is the acquisition of knowledge skills and attitude with practice that bring permanent change in behavior.

Teaching is the imparting of knowledge skills and attitudes, for example, new facts counting co-operation and team work.

In the past a popular educational teaching method was informal teaching. Learning consisted of children imitating or modeling their behavior that of their elders learning through observation play. The elders were therefore teachers or role models.

The teacher creates the course content to be taught, teaching materials, methods to use and then enforce the learning. These methods/strategies/ styles of instruction are referred to as **pedagogy**. Resources that helps teachers teach better include:

- Schemes of work
- Lesson plan
- Instructional media.

For effective teaching to take place an appropriate method must be adopted by the teacher.

Important points consider when choosing teaching methods includes:

- Students back ground knowledge/ entry behavior
- Environment
- Learning goals.

Although students learn in different ways, have different attention spans, respond differently, it is true they all respond well to praise. A variety of strategies are used to ensure that all students have equal opportunities to learn. They include:

1. question and answer
2. explaining
3. demonstrating
4. experiment
5. educational visits
6. dramatization
7. role-play-where children imitate familiar situations, for example, family settings, school settings & church
8. Collaboration-having children work in groups
9. Singing

Collaboration

It allows children to talk amongst each other and listen to all points of view. It therefore enhances „giving chances“ during participation and helps students to think in unbiased way. The teacher can assess children's ability to co-operation, team spirit, leadership skills or presentation abilities.

Songs

Songs can be used to various concepts, for example, color, shapes and weather. They also reinforce learnt concept (familiar songs)

Behavior change/ modify behavior

Teach good health practices

They should be short, purposeful, meaningful and full of actions.

Effective teaching methods therefore, enhance:

- coverage of lessons / content
- acquisition of skills and attitudes
- equal opportunities for students
- Achievements of objectives.

2.2 EFFECTIVE CLASSROOM TEACHING

Effective classroom teaching is dependent on:

1. Good classroom communication between teachers and learners is the easiest method.

Education must build on the relationship between the instructor and student. Fenton and O'Leary (1) suggested that educators focus on mutual communication. For learning to take place, a dissemination of information from instructor to student and student to instructor must occur. This communication process is often where the learning breakdown occurs.

Communication occurs when a message is received and understood in the manner intended. (2) Miscommunication results when the communication skills of the sender or receiver are lacking. Effective communication includes the ability to read and comprehend information, the ability to express ideas effectively in written and spoken form and the ability to listen attentively. (3) An instructor's verbal, nonverbal and listening skills greatly influence student's achievement and retention.

Verbal skills include vocabulary, pronunciation, grammar, vocal rate, pitch and intensity. Nonverbal skills include body language (posture, gestures and facial expressions), paralanguage (voice emphasis, pause and tone), eye contact and dress. Listening, the least developed component of effective communication, is the process of receiving, constructing meaning from and responding to spoken and/or nonverbal messages. (4) Fenton and O'Leary (1) found that instructors trained in communication skills reported changed instructional behaviors and improved student attitudes and achievement.

According to Mahler, (5) an individual's personality determines his or her channel of communication and influences perception of the message. Knowing the proper channels for communication and understanding diverse personalities helps ensure that the message is understood by the receiver and the receiver's needs are met. In addition, different personality types have different motivational and psychological needs. (6) It is very difficult for an instructor to meet the varied needs of students, especially if the educator has not been trained to recognize and respond to those needs. Meeting student' needs is crucial for academic achievement. (7,8)

Instructors have their own motivational and psychological needs that are exhibited through their mode of communication, teaching methodology and learning strategies. Instructors usually prefer teaching methods that reflect their learning styles and meet personal needs. At the same time, instructors expect students to be motivated by their chosen teaching methods. (9-12) When 2 individuals have the same interests, motivation and psychological needs, more communication occurs. (10) Learning and communication in the classroom are more difficult when different personalities are involved.

2. Use of appropriate instructional media (materials that facilitate learning) since students enter into schools with varying degrees of abilities and potential.

Types of instructional media and their application in practical teaching

As earlier mentioned appropriate instructional media enhances learning. Effectiveness therefore implies how well educational goals and objectives are achieved. Generally, media are categorized:

- Print
- Non print
- Audio
- Visual
- Audio-Visual
- Non-electronics

Some of the instructional media considered relevant to teachers include:

Print media

It is one of the oldest media in education. They are useful for informational or motivational purposes. They are used to convey verbal information through print.

They form the most widely used media in education. They include text books, periodicals, encyclopedia, newspapers, magazines and minutes. They provide good source for teachers to structure their lessons and make notes. Sometimes they carry their main responsibility of organizing teaching and they can be used as basic instructional guides. Newspapers and magazines plus other prints mentioned are also very relevant for subjects in social science and art. Information contained in them can be very current. Therefore, print media can be used to supplement other media with chalk and chalk board.

Chalk and chalk board

They can be used as instructional mediums. They are temporary and when integrated with other media they can give full information. They also enhance teachers' classroom presentation in all subject areas. Neatness of the chalk board should be ensured by the use of guidelines, compass

fingers straight, edged rulers etc. The chalk board should be divided into sections and lettering should be done from the left to the right. The teacher can also choose to use only the middle part of the chalk board. Chalk to be used for teaching should be in form of wedges and cones. Colored chalks may be used when it is appropriate e.g. to show parts of the drawings or on teaching points.

Regalia

These are real objects or things as opposed to models or representations. They include coins, tools, artifacts, (gourds calabashes. e t c) plants, animals, fruits, utensils e t c Specimen, exhibits, cut away objects are classifications used for regalia. Regalia has great value in every subject. The use of regalia in science, for example creates a lot of interest in children. They learn how to look after animals, care for small insect's e t c. Students also get involved in learning. Regalia eliminates distortion of information in students' knowledge on the topics being taught or being covered. They provide the children with an opportunity for` hands` on experience and interactions.

Still pictures

They are non – projected, non-motion pictures used for teaching. They can be photograph representations of people or things.

They are readily available for resourceful trainee teachers.

They are found in newspapers, magazines text books e t c.

When still pictures are properly mounted on cardboards, they can be used to pass across wide range of information.

Models and mock- ups

Models and mock-ups are three dimensional representation of a real thing. So it has a width, length, breadth and even height. Models are representations of real things that are infinitely large like the earth, solar system or real things that are small whether animate (animal) or inanimate (not animals).

They may be complete in every detail or not detailed.

Some models can be disassembled for learner's close observation.

On the other hand, mock-ups are differentiated from models by their moving and operating parts. (mock-ups can move).

Models and mock-up are mostly applied in physics, geography, biology, chemistry and generally science.

They can be bought commercially or made using paper Mache.

Audio media

Audio media offers a wide range of opportunities for group or individual use. They can be used to deliver instruction verbally or to guide learning and motor skills.

With the availability of small compact cassette recorder, trainee teachers can tape themselves while teaching or their children while receiving instruction and this can be used by the teacher later to correct their teaching styles.

Students can be involved in the production of learning materials using audio media.

Slides and projectors

Slide projectors are used to project slides.

The slides are small photographic transparencies either in color or black and white. They are used to transmit instructional content.

They are less expensive than films and can be stored for future use. Their presentations can be accompanied with print or audio recording.

Computers in education

Computers are playing an important role in education for both the teacher and the student.

Their use enables each student to develop at his/her own pace and makes the whole learning process more flexible.

-Children are usually interested by computer games, computer graphics and occupies most of their leisure time. Computer packages allow the sketching of shapes. Designs can be scanned edited, colored worked and re-worked. This sketching enables children to develop control of their muscles. e g auto care enables the user to design mechanical parts e.g. the transmission of fuel in an automobile etc.

Advantages of using instructional media

- They make learning interesting. Facilitates and encourages learning.
- Enables self-careful selection and organization of subject content as well as improving content delivery.
- It standardizes delivery of content since learners with different abilities can receive the same message and the instructional media caters for individual differences.
- They make teaching practical and enjoyable.
- The changing learning images reduces boredom in learners.
- They promote student-student interaction, teacher-student interaction and teacher-teacher interaction due to feedback, reinforcement and learner's participation.
- They save teaching time because media requires a short time to present large information.

3. Teacher characteristics

- Academic performance
- Professional training
- Zeal / enthusiasm in teaching
- Self-drive / willingness to work.
- Genuinty
- Independence of thought, attitude etc.
- Motivation and ability to motivate others in class
- Interdependence –realizing you are not know-it-all
- Team builder

4. Classroom organization

The selection on building of an ECDE should meet the following criteria:

- The center should be situated within a walking distance of the children's home because it is easy to get to school and the child will not feel removed from their surroundings.
- The site should have enough out door space for each child. It must be well drained, fenced and sheltered from strong winds

- The buildings should include toilets or latrines and outdoor playing equipment's
- The rooms should be well ventilated and have proper lighting
- The rooms must be free from draught (excess heat and sun shine)
- The rooms must have adequate space for the number of children using it (should be 1m^2)
- The center should have proper sanitary facilities such as a supply of clean drinking water, water for washing hands and for other activities. (hygiene, cleanliness)
- The play space should be about 25m^2 , located outside and next to the building because it makes it easy to combine indoor and outdoor activities.

A well-organized classroom should be presented as follows:

- Classroom should be tidy, swept, clean, the furniture is dusted and the earth is watered to keep the dust down.
- Everything is in its rightful place i.e. the pupil's desks, teacher's table and learning area.
- The display of charts, mobiles etc. are properly hanged on the wall and roof rafters.
- The learning area such as science corner, shop corner etc. should be well established.
- The desks should be arranged to allow easy movement, group work and to enable the teacher to secure control of group behaviors.
- The teacher and the pupils should look interested and busy. A teacher should organize the pupils sitting in the class room in the following format:
 - a) The desks should be arranged in groups to allow for free movement
 - b) There should be a large space at the center of the room for dramatization and story telling
 - c) The groups should be flexible to accommodate the demands of varying activities.
 - d) The chairs should be easy to turn to enable the pupils to face the teacher before he/she begins to teach.
 - e) Bright pupils should be seated near the slow learners for help and encouragement
 - f) The teacher should consider interest, ability, gender and special needs of the grouping of pupils.

5. Class room environment

This can be defined as the quality of the classroom life as reflected by the relationship between the teacher and the pupil and between the pupils themselves. Effective learning depends largely on a positive supportive classroom environment which is promoted by the teacher's positive attitude, his beliefs & assumptions about children's learning styles

To facilitate a positive classroom environment, the teacher should:

- Deal with important interpersonal issues when and as they arise and not leaving them until later.
- Talk directly to children rather than about them to the class as a whole (not discuss about them with others).
- Speak to the pupils with courtesy, care and considerations.
- Being aware of the importance of eye contact and nonverbal communication.
- Avoid common blocks to effective communication e g judging, criticizing, commanding etc.

Learning areas

Certain areas of the class room should be kept as learning centers or activity areas. They are set ups meant to enhance learning of topics taught in specific subjects or activity areas. They should be kept as separate areas to enable the children to concentrate on one activity at a time. It should be set up in child centered manner rather than a teacher centered manner.

Importance of learning areas

- The stimulate learning by arousing children's curiosity.
- They teach children to work by themselves
- They pre-occupy pupils usefully in their free time
- They help integrate learning in many subjects
- They reinforce what the children have learnt (use theory and practical)
- They make learning calm & alive (lively)
- They help slow learners to use several of their senses to enhance learning.

Establishing learning centers

Some important considerations in establishment of a learning centers include:

- Topics or theme
- Size of class(space)
- Learners level
- Learners age
- Height of children
- Locality
- Environment
- Availability of resources
- Teachers creativity
- Security
- Pupils interests

Some learning areas include:

- nature corner-insects, plants, flowers, seedlings, horns, hooves
- home corner-utensils, shoes, dolls, puppets
- water and sand corner-bottles, water, straws, tins, sieves, soap
- art and construction corner-blocks, maize cobs, sisal fibers, beads
- music corner-shakers, sisal skirts, drums, kaymakams, flutes
- shop corner
- toy corner

Using and maintaining learning areas

- Plan the lesson to involve the children in activities that require them to use the learning areas.
- This should be easy if the teacher had in mind the objective of the lesson in his/her scheme of work before establishing the learning areas

- Keep everything in its rightful place at the end of the lesson and leave the learning area tidy
- Keep the materials in the science corner fresh and dust free
- Appoint some children to keep the learning areas including the chalk board clean
- Remove old charts and outdated materials (that have ceased the learners) and place new ones.
- The materials and activities in the corners should be related to the theme if using thematic approach.
- Physical boundaries across the centers should be clearly defined.
- Children should know acceptable limits for the use of materials.

6. Class grouping

A) Grouping by age

Children can be grouped according to their age because of their similarities in development.

This lessens the work of the teacher as well as the children because there will be a more streamlined way of following from one activity area to another. For the children, they are able to relate better in class and to understand better.

B) Gender grouping

Children in pre-school do not discriminate in their interaction but rather sexual differences start being defined progressively when they enter formal schooling or at around the age of 7. Children need to learn about their differences in terms of gender. They need to learn to relate to each other as a group rather than seeing one as more or less important compared to another. It is necessary for teachers to treat both boys and girls in a similar way and to involve them in similar activities during learning. If the differences in interest in activities shows, let it not be because the teacher enforced it but rather the learner's e.g if a boy is playing with a doll don't stop him. Such a child may have a male role model.

c) Ability grouping

Advantage of this grouping is that a teacher is able to deal with children of the same ability at once as she moves round the class and also avails opportunities for children to move according to their class.

7. Class control

All children need to know that they are loved, accepted, and approved of in the preschool and they also need to learn how to handle limits and frustrations they meet in the day to day living. Not all children come to pre- school with the same ability to handle emotions or the day to day frustrations of living. Some express themselves in healthy ways while others may take the role of a baby reverting to an earlier safer time. Others will explode being unable to face even the smallest frustration without rushing out.

Studies have shown that children need, physical care and parents or adults who will provide them with love and understanding and who are able to respond to them attentively and sensitively.

Ways of class control

Discipline

This is a means of helping children develop their inner control to do what is approved and act in approved ways. It should be discussed with parents to ensure consistency in discipline. Some children come from homes where physical punishment, threats and abuse are used. Such children find it difficult to relate to a teacher who doesn't shout, threaten or beat them. Others come from homes where there is no control. Children need to learn new ways of expressing emotions and feelings that are socially acceptable and do not interfere with their means of learning and others.

Dealing with misbehavior

- Distract the children's attention with another toy or activity
- Positive re-direction: Re-direct an unacceptable behavior e.g. throwing books and crayons, the children can give them out therefore displaying acceptable behavior.
- Say it: Tell the children to say what they are feeling

- Natural consequences e.g. if a child throws materials twice away he/she should not be allowed to play with them. This helps the children to make the connection between their behavior and their impact.
- Choices: Make a child feel responsible for his/ her actions preferably those that lead to the same desirable behavior.
- Touching: Physically guide a child to pick up a book they have thrown and take them to the required shelves.
- Eye contacts: Direct eye contact helps children to stop negative behavior.
- Time out: This should be done sparingly. The amount of time a child sits in the time out should not be more than their age in minutes. Time out can also be that the child is following you but doing nothing. This encourages children to think about consequences of their behavior.

ACTIVITY

- i) Discuss teacher's assumption about children's learning styles.
- ii) Describe the determinants of effective classroom teaching.
- iii) Discuss ways of disciplining pre-school children to enhance learning.

LESSON 3: TEACHING LEARNING APPROACHES

Introduction

This lesson discusses pertinent teaching approaches relevant to pre-school teaching and how they influence the learning of young children. Related concepts have also been defined sufficiently. These approaches include: Teacher centered approach, Child centered approach, Thematic approach, Integrated approach, Individualized learning approach, learning through play, group teaching, exploration and discovery and dialogue approach.

3.1 Child-Centered approach (C.C.M/ C.C A)

This is an approach in education that recognizes the importance of matching the content and the methods of learning to children development and the basic needs and characteristic of children centered learning. The teacher plays a minimal role in exploring a new material and allows the learners to find and create new material familiar to the one provided. Therefore, he focuses his mind on the child's interests, capabilities, reactions and responses. The teacher poses a problem for the learner to solve or he may also assign a task which results in individual learning. This method is also called heuristic method which is used for measuring the average capability of individual children.

Characteristics

It is used for measuring average capability:

- There is a happy relaxed but busy atmosphere.
- There are more pupil activities than teacher activities.
- There is good display of visual aids that encourage display of materials.
- Pupils work is carefully displayed in class
- No corporal punishment, no meaningless memorization
- There are many interesting and well stocked learning centers. Children learn from known to unknown.

Advantages:

- It enhances retention of knowledge as children use more than one sense in learning.
- It leads to holistic development of children cognitive motor (physical)
- The teacher identifies children and assists those with special needs.
- The teacher recognizes the interest of the children. Children are able to discover, explore and find out this for themselves and hence more learning take place.

3.2 Teacher-Centered method

In this method the teacher is most active during a lesson. Knowledge is banked into the child before he/she is ready for it. This method is called expository or banking method. Learners are passive receivers of knowledge in quantity or quality. The teacher does not consider the age of the child e.g. lecture (telling method)

Characteristics

The teacher selects the contents to be learned, where and when to be learned. Children are passive listeners. Pupils are regarded as uniform group of learners rather than individual with different gifts, abilities and needs. The teacher spends most of the time talking

Disadvantages

- Children use limited senses. What is learnt is easily forgotten.
- No learning especially where the teacher is absent.
- It is geared towards working through the syllabus rather than imparting learning, hence the slow learners are ignored.
- Since the teacher dominates the learning process children are given no room to express their views.

3.3. Thematic Approach

Thematic is derived from the word theme, which means a broad topic in which learning is based. Subject / activity areas are concentrated on the sub topic of interest e.g. a topic like the family can be used to teach in all activity areas.

A theme may take a long or shorter time depending on the scope (depth content). It is used to introduce children to activities that require active explorations, problem solving and acquisition of specific skills and concepts. The learning areas are integrated (put together) especially in a scheme of work. The teacher should be flexible and use their imagination when using the approach.

Characteristics

- Many activities are incorporated together.
- Arrangements of learning corners portray a theme being learned.
- Teachers know the different skills, knowledge and attitudes to be developed in different activity areas.

Writing skills	Number value	Imagination
Draw utensils	Count utensils	modelling
	Rote learning	painting

- It takes into account children's interests, needs and abilities.
- There is flexibility in choice of the items to be used in learning.
- Learning activities are within the pace of learning.

Advantages:

- Flexibility in choice of things makes learning easy.
- A wide coverage of content is ensured.
- It is economical in terms of resources.
- Teachers can prepare learning materials in advance.
- One can select the theme depending on the time of the year, the occasion and other events.
- Teachers can continually assess children as they participate in activity areas.
- There is a good flow of ideas and easy grasping of content because what is taught in class is also found outside.

3.4. Learning through play

-Playing is the most natural method through which children learn and experience the world around them. In role play and pretext play children can pretend to be the personalities that they are role modeling.

-They imitate the impressions they get from the world around them using imagination. They develop a feeling of autonomy / freedom and this gives them satisfaction, a chance to express their talents and they also learn in depth what they know.

3.5. Child instructor interaction method (dialogue method)

In this method the teacher learns from the pupils and the pupils learn from the teacher as they discuss different events and happenings. Children are taught what they know and what they don't know. Learning is practically interactive.

3.6. Peer teaching

This is where children who grasp contents faster are encouraged to help others in a group or as an individual. This method is also called child-child approach. The assignment of who will be teacher or pupil is done by the instructor.

3.7. Individual teaching

Individual teaching has 2 levels.

- Where the teacher takes the weak child or a slow learner and teaches him or her concept that he did not grasp in a classroom situation
- Where a child learns by himself e.g. a child may take a book, read a paragraph, do an exercise and give the teacher for marking

The child learns concepts according to his interest

Exploration

It is a common habit for children when in a new environment to walk around, look around, and touch things/objects around in order to know more about them. This is referred to as exploration. At an early age children demonstrate tendency to explore. Freedom and opportunities should therefore be given to children in order to enhance their exploration skills as well as ensure their security and safety.

Discovery

Discovery involves the process of finding out. It is through discovery that children come up with new knowledge and ideas. They settle and attend to something uncovered or made obvious to them by their own interest and activities. Through the use of their senses, they gain knowledge. According to research, discovery is an eye-widener. It feels good with discovery and exploration that children observe, explore materials, collect information, discover, represent, figure out components, construct own understanding, apply all rules and create personal meaning to knowledge.

The methods create confidence to learners and provide a wide range of knowledge. It encourages all round development in the child thus helping to fulfill one of the basic aims of ECDE.

Learning through Exploration and Discovery Method

Children are always eager to test with new things and events. This curious behavior enables them to gain knowledge about the environment. Analysts in children's behavior agree that young children are natural explorers. They do not need to be pushed or forced to explore the

environment. They have an inherent desire and tendency to do so. This leads to discovery and exploration which are important methods of learning in young children.

Teacher's Role in Learning through Discovery and Exploration

Successful exploration and discovery does not just happen. It calls for the teachers' professional intervention in:

- Formulating specific, measurable, achievable, relevant and time bound (SMART) objectives.
- Acting in a manner that;
 - Arouses and sustains interest in learning
 - Allows children to exercise choice and judgement
 - Focuses the children's attention on the resources from which they can make their own discoveries.
 - Can help the children to acquire learning skills such as concentration
 - Observation and manipulation, which are pre-requisites for learning

Arrant (1993) refers to it as monitoring system. In this method, little teachers; supplement the work of teachers by communicating to each other those lessons that have been taught by the master teacher. It helps fast learners to exercise their talents and gifts. This is beneficial, as it requires them to understand the content as a result of responsibility given to them. The method is suitable in teaching practical skills such as tying shoe laces and social behavior such as relating events accurately, road safety, daily routine and others. It's relevance in teaching young children is clearly seen from:

- The way children contribute, critic and actively get involved in the learning process due to freedom with their peers.
- It is an approach where children of different age groups are catered for simultaneously.
- The kind of flexibility in grouping of children according to their varied abilities.

3.8 Group Teaching

This is learning that takes place when children are put in groups. In particular groups, children learn from one another concepts, attitudes, skills and even morals. The teacher may give different instructions to different groups in the same class. This is a situation whereby children are collectively taught together as a group at a particular place and time.

Advantages

- Children develop social skills for interactions
- The Approach also strengthens children's cognitive abilities
- Children can see alternative points of views of other and adjust their thinking to that of the group.
- Ego-centralism is reduced as children recognize and appreciate ideas of others and see same events in different ways.
- The approach is economical to the teacher in terms of preparation, planning, money and time.
- It is useful where equipment and materials are limited.
- Management is easy as children are involved in performing similar tasks at the same time.
- It enhances sense of belongingness.

Disadvantages

- It disregards children's individual differences
- The method encourages a great deal of passive learning.
- It does not promote individual abilities and interests.
- It is difficult to evaluate
- Has a limited child-teacher interaction?

While using group-teaching approach, it is important for the teacher to note that:

- Children have a short attention span and therefore cannot sit still for long.
- Children are naturally egocentric in their way of thinking

When working with children in a group therefore, teachers need to be aware of the following:

- Accept children's natural behaviors such as talking, dancing, wiggling, squirming etc. since they are young and are not expected to behave like adults.
- Keep group activities short, flexible and spontaneous.
- Have close supervision as learners interact in their groups.
- Begin with something interesting to attract children and enable them settle down in their groups
- Ensure maximum participation of all children.

3.9 Learning through exploration and discovery

Children learn through exploring and discovering the environment around their school and their home

ACTIVITY

- i) Distinguish between individual teaching and group teaching approaches.
- ii) Discuss the teacher's role during learning using individualized approach.
- iii) Educational visits are extensions of learning programmes. Prepare a schedule of activities that a pre-school teacher needs to engage when planning for a field trip.

LESSON 4: CLASSROOM MANAGEMENT



Objective

By the end of this LESSON the learner should be able to:

- i) Discuss the characteristics of an effective teacher.***
- ii) Explain the importance of discipline in a pre-school class.***
- iii) Discuss ways of disciplining children in pre-school.***

Introduction

This lesson will discuss the importance of classroom management and the essential skills a teacher should have to enhance learning through good classroom management. The aspects of classroom organization and discipline will also be brought to perspective.

Effective classroom management requires a teacher to have the following skills that identify with the class and shows an awareness of everything happening in that class, names of children in the class, size of that class and space of the class.

4.1 CHARACTERISTICS OF AN EFFECTIVE TEACHER

Wittiness

- The teacher seems to have eyes at the back to spot what the children are doing, saying or not doing.
- They have a cunning way of identifying children with misbehavior promptly and the right child has to be caught in mischief.
- They sit or stand where they can see all the children during the lesson.
- They make frequent eye contact to ensure all parts of the class are in his view.
- They stand at an angle to write on the BB and also be able to see the class
- They move around the class and when they stop to help a child, they make sure they help other children as well.

Overlapping

- Overlapping is handling more than 2 duties at the same time. It involves making eye contact with, moving closer and standing behind a misbehaving child as you continue to control the class activity.
- It also involves directing a question to a child who is not paying attention in order to capture his concentration.
- The teacher acknowledges raised hand with a nod or with other non-verbal signs or signals to avoid distracting children who are concentrating in a class activity.
- The teacher uses gestures to stop a child from misbehaving without drawing the attention of other children
- It also involves removing distracting objects without disrupting classroom discussions.

4.2 MANAGING MOVEMENT

This refers to regulating pace and flow of classroom activities. It involves:

- Organization of demonstration materials in advance
- Training the children to be ready for a lesson without wasting time by providing a class time table and having children books out before the teacher comes
- Facilitating movement of the children from one part of the room to another. (create enough space and children put up hands when they want to move and ask for permission).

4.3 GROUP FOCUS

This involves keeping children alert and accountable through instructional techniques. This is achieved through:

- Pacing activities in a way to maintain interest.
- Distributing questions appropriately and widely
- Keep children alert (ensure eye contact)
- Avoid choral responses/answers
- Move around the room to ensure that learning is taking place in a given assignment.

4.4 CLASSROOM ORGANIZATION

The teacher should ensure that tables, chairs or desks are well organized to ease movement to the learning center/areas. Learning center should be well supplied and accessible.

-The grouping of children should depend on age, ability, gender, interest etc. -The class should be clean and well lit, ventilated etc.

4.5 CLASSROOM DISCIPLINE

Discipline is a system of guiding individuals to desirable behaviors. The aim of discipline should be to produce individuals who can make their own decision reasonably and responsibly. It is good to note that children are unique with different endowment from different environments, different gifts and needs

How to discipline

1. When you are disciplining be relevant.

Let the child know their mistakes. Explain to him why you are not happy about the behavior, take immediate actions. It should be effected immediately after the event so that the child can associate or relate.

2. Be consistent

The consequences of a certain behavior should be the same at all times and with all children regardless of their background.

3. Be proportional to the act (misbehavior) done. The teacher should not misplace her stress on her children.

4. Avoid corporal punishment because it is illegal.

Advice on discipline

- Behavior modification techniques should be applied for discipline to be possible
- Be a role model
- Make few and simple rules with children and let them understand the consequences.
- The teacher should love the children and to know their needs and reasons for their behavior

- encourage and praise good efforts
- create an interesting learning environment like providing enough learning materials
- do not punish poor performance

Techniques of sustaining pupils' interest

- Provide opportunities where children can move about explore and observe
- Take care of individual interests
- Provide adequate and variety learning materials
- Give age-appropriate activities
- Reward children's efforts generously and sincerely
- Vary methods of teaching
- Involve children in the ongoing activities and cultivate self-esteem.

ACTIVITY

1. Identify and describe with examples 10 characteristics of a teacher that promote learning in pre-school class.
2. Construct one instructional medium for pre-school with a write up showing:
 - a) materials used for construction
 - b) Activity areas for its use and how it can be used
 - c) Its advantages and disadvantages for that particular age group.
3. Discuss the aspect of overlapping in a classroom situation.

LESSON 5: ECDE PROFESSIONAL DOCUMENTS



Objectives

By the end of this LESSON the learner should be able to;

- a) Identify and define the professional records which a n ECDE teacher should have*
- b) Describe the purpose and contents of these professional records*
- c) Prepare relevant and appropriate scheme of work, lesson plans, timetables and progress records for ECDE*

Introduction

Professional documents refer to those helpful gadgets prepared by a teacher as official guides to the teaching/learning process. They include the syllabus, Scheme of work (S. O.W), Lesson plan, progressive record, class time table, class register, health record among others.

5.1 THE SYLLABUS

Burton and Green, (1972) defined a syllabus as a statement of study-the amount of knowledge and selection of knowledge which it is proposed that a pupil should acquire.

Purpose of a syllabus

The purpose of the syllabus is to list objectives of the subject's content and items covered in each school term or year.

To achieve the above purposes, the following considerations are made by syllabus designers:

- National goals of education-the goals of education in the country where the syllabus will be used and the goals should reflect the needs of the nation.
- Aims of education-the general aims of the educational system and the aims across all levels of education.
- Aims of teaching the subject –the importance of a subject in the curriculum and how it fulfils or contributes towards achieving the goals of education

- Adequacy of content in relation to time allocated
- The level for which the syllabus will be operational-pre-primary, primary, secondary or university.
- Intellectual level or developmental level of the targeted group.
- Resources available-physical and human resources which will make the syllabus operational
- The physical, psychological and emotional needs of the learners for whom the syllabus is designed

Parts of the ECD syllabus.

- Language activities. Children need language to communicate. Through language activities children are able to express their desires, excitements, amusements and disappointments. It is an important tool for facilitating learning.
- Physical and psychomotor activities.
- Math's activities
- Science activities
- Music and movement activities
- Social activities
- Religious activities
- Life-skill activities
- Outdoor activities

5.2 SCHEME OF WORK

A scheme of work is a teacher's plan on how he or she intends to cover the syllabus or part of the syllabus in a specified period of time. It interprets the syllabus into units that can be used in a learning / teaching situation. Nasibi and Kio 1995 defined it as a breakdown of the syllabus into manageable units which could be covered in a specific period of time, lasting either week (s), month(s) or a whole year.

Purpose of scheme of work

A scheme of work serves the following purposes:

- To plan on the presentation of activities so that the related activities are grouped to minimize repetition and manage time properly
- To develop logical presentation of the lesson
- To make teaching both systematic and orderly starting with the simplest topic to the most complex
- To ensure that every topic in the scheme is covered
- To enable the teacher plan for time wisely giving room for events and activities which might interfere with the school calendar such as public holidays, prize giving days, sports day and so on.
- To enable the teacher, prepare in advance relevant instructional materials for use in the lesson.
- To check the teachers pace of teaching
- To help in smooth continuity of teaching/learning during transition from one level to the next.

Elements of a scheme of work

The following constitute elements of a scheme of work:

- Administrative information indicating activity areas, class, term and year when the schemes would be operational. The title is also included here.
- The week when a certain theme would be taught.
- The period or lesson when a specific theme would be taught which varies with themes.
- Objectives, which specify what the learners are expected to achieve at the end of the lesson.
- The content (theme and sub themes) to be covered in a given lesson
- Learning activities which the learners are expected to carry out.
- Resources-teaching / learning materials which the teacher uses to facilitate learning.
- References-text books and other printed materials that the teacher uses or refers when scheming or planning to teach such as reference books, magazines and the like.

- Remarks-comment a teacher makes after teaching a given lesson.
- Evaluation-it involves assessment of achievement of the children

Scheme of Work

Duration	Theme	Sub-theme	objectives	Teaching/ learning	Teaching/ Learning Resources	Reference	Remarks
Week 1	Our family	Fam idly me me rest	By the end of this sub- theme the children should be able to: 1.Name members of the family 2.count them 3Sing songs about them 4.draw, model, color and paint 5 Role-play Different family members	The children will accomplish is: Naming Counting g Singing Drawing Modeling g Coloring g Painting Role-playing	Pictures Flash cards Dolls Clay/ Plasticize Paints Crayons water	ECDE Syllabus NACECE Activity Books 1, 2,&3 Hand book for ECDE	Done
Week2- Week 12							

5.3 LESSON PLAN

Definition: A lesson plan is a documented preparation of all the activities that are intended to take place during the teaching/learning session with children at the ECDE center, including the sequence in which the activities flow. It is also referred to as a daily programmer of activities.

Purpose of a lesson plan

The purpose of a lesson plan is understood to be as follows:

- It is used as a basis for lesson presentation. A lesson gives the teacher agenda or outline to follow as the teaching /learning takes place.
- It enables the teacher to be familiar with the intended content and to visualize the best way of covering it.
- It helps the teacher to avoid vagueness and irrelevancies since it serves as a guide or road map on the content
- It serves as a memory bank, reminding the teacher of the main point to focus on during the lesson.
- It gives the teacher security and confidence, especially to a beginning teacher. A teacher with a good lesson plan can walk into a class room with confidence gained from having a well-developed and organized frame work for a particular lesson.
- It acts as an orderly sequencing of content and learning activities in a lesson.
- It improves the teacher's performance by acting as a basis for lesson monitoring, evaluation and future planning.

Elements of a lesson plan

A good lesson plan has the following:

Administrative details: This shows subject or activity area, age, class, date when the lesson is to be conducted, for example 25th May 2008, time or duration of the lesson for example, 9.30 am-10.00 am and roll. Administrative details must be indicated at the top of the lesson plan.

Theme and sub theme: This is the name of the unit or sub unit in the syllabus. It shows the topic or subject matter to be taught that day.

Objectives: These are the same objectives stated in the scheme of work. When transferred to the lesson plan, they must be broken into what is to be achieved in one lesson of thirty minutes. The objectives in the lesson plan are specific to instructional activities of the particular lesson.

Content: It is the exact information to be passed to the children under the topic being taught. It is to be presented at three levels: Introduction, lesson development and conclusion.

Materials: Are the learning aids used by both the children and the teacher during the lesson development.

References: These are the books used by the teacher during lesson preparation and development.

Remarks: These are comments made by the teacher after teaching.

Sample format

Class	Age	Date	Time	Roll
Pre-primary	4-5 years old	20 th /may/2008	8.20-12.00	30

Theme: Our family

Sub-theme: family members

Objectives:

Children should be able to:

- Identify and name the members of their family.
- Role-play members of the family
- Count members of the family.
- Model, draw, color, paint pictures of the family members
- Sing songs and tell stories about their family members.

Materials: picture books, flash cards, dolls, clay, paint, paint brushes, water, crayons.

References:

NACECE Early Childhood Development Guidelines.

Here you can indicate any other references you have used.

5.4 LESSON DEVELOPMENT:

Introduction. (5 minutes)

The teacher/caregiver introduces the theme about a family by a contemporary illustration of related people who live together in a home. The children in turns name members of their families. Children can sing a familiar song relating to the family.

Teachers activity	Children's activity
Step 1	
Step 2	
Step 3	
Step 4	
Step 5	

Remarks:

The teacher will have to evaluate and comment on how the lesson proceeded. For example, a teacher may write: Lesson well conducted, 50% of the children were able to answer all the questions.

5.5 CLASS TIME TABLE

A time table is a schedule showing the type of experiences that children are supposed to be involved in every day. It is both a planning as well as an organizing tool in a school. Planning involves specification of events that are set ahead of time. Organization on the other hand involves placing both human and material resources in an orderly way for the smooth running of events.

Time for each learning activity in ECDE is 30 minutes. The timetable should be well displayed for all to see

Sample Time table

DAY	TIME									
	Arrival to 8.30 am	8.30- 8.50	8.50- 9.20	9.20- 9.50	9.50- 10.20	10.20- 11.00	11.00- 11.30	11.30- 12.00	12.00	2.00 pm
MON	Free Act	Health Check	Lang Act.	Math act	out door	B R E A K S N A C	Scio act	Create. act	L U N C H O M E	Rest
TUE	Free	Health	Lang Act.	M A	Out		Scio	Create. Act		Rest
WED	Free	H C	Lang Act	MA	Out		Scio	Create. Act		Rest
THUR	Free	H C	Lang Act	MA	out		Scio	Create Act		Rest
FRI	Free	H C	Lang	MA	out		skies	Creat.		Rest

Purpose of a time table

A time table has the following uses:

- It indicates who should perform a certain task in order to accomplish the objectives set.
- It determines when teaching is to be done.
- As an organizing tool, it enables division of labor, that is, a clear distribution of the tasks to be undertaken.
- It ensures allocation of the teaching load fairly to each member of staff according to qualification, competence and areas of interest.
- It coordinates the teaching in each subject in a given class to avoid any clash or overloading in timing of various activities of a particular class.

5.6 RECORD OF WORK

It should be written weekly

DATE	THEME/SUB-THEME	CONTENT COVERED	REFERENCES	REMARKS
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ACTIVITY

1. Discuss the details of three professional records in pre-school.
2. Explain the elements of a health record.
3. Prepare a one-week scheme of work and a one-day lesson plan for pre-school under the theme „the home“.

LESSON 6: MODERN THEORIES ASSOCIATED WITH INSTRUCTIONAL METHODS IN ECD



Objective

By the end of this lesson the learner should be able to:

1. Explain the contributions of;

- *Maria Montessori*
- *Fredrick Froebel*
- *Jean Planet*
- *John Dewey to ECDE*

Introduction

In this lesson various theories associated instructional methods in ECD will be discussed. As you saw in the definition of terms; a theory is a set of assumptions as a result of research to explain a certain phenomenon and a model is a design representing the real thing. The theories and models helps to explain how well a curriculum can be developed and implemented.

6.1 MARIA MONTESSORI (1870-1952)

Maria Montessori was the first woman medical doctor in Italy. She developed great interest in working with mentally handicapped children, when she served as a director of a special school.

PRINCIPLES OF MONTESSORI

-Respect the child

Montessori felt that each child is an individual and should be treated so. Children are small adults and should be given age appropriate activities. Having children doing things on their own encourages/ creates independence and this helps development of self-esteem.

-Absorbent mind

Children can directly absorb knowledge from the environment and from other materials into their minds. With this understanding she valued sensory learning i.e. (learning by use of senses)

-Sensitive period (stages of development in children)

She understood that children have periods in life when they can learn and perform a certain activity. This is especially true in the development of speech.

-The prepared environment

A child learns well in a preferred environment. The work of the care giver, teacher, Parents should be to prepare the environment for the child.

The child should do the activity for himself. He should be free to choose an activity for himself according to interest but the freedom should be to protect each child rights. According to Montessori the teacher's role is that of a directress. Her work is to make children the center of learning by preparing for them the environment and a series of activities to perform. She should also encourage children to use freedom which should enhance responsibility in them.

The teachers should observe children establish their interest and be able to prepare a next environment. The teacher should identify the sensitive period, observe the activities and discourage unacceptable behavior. Montessori encouraged teaching using real objects-regalia. She felt that the teacher should give enough time for each activity to enhance enjoyment and maximum participation. Do not insist.

6.2 FREDRICK FROEBEL (1782-1852)

Froebel was a German educator who believed that education was a way of helping children grow and develop in all aspects.

Froebel likened a teacher to a gardener who prepares the ground and sets a stage for growth. With occasional and regular weeding and adding fertilizer she sits back for growth to occur.

A teacher of young children is a guide, a motivator and a leader for children's learning. Therefore, he created the kindergarten and designed the Froebel gifts and blocks. These included toys games and he also instituted nurturing plants in school garden.

He introduced the Froebel Ian star. This is an eight pointed star that is usually found on Christmas tree. He introduced the concept of learning institution.

He believed that children dripped in stages and each stage should be properly exploited for proper growth.

Just like plants children require time and resources to grow.

He also felt that play is important as a method of learning.

Children learn what they are ready to learn, e g simple additions in pre-school and lower. He believed that children are born innocent and should be protected from evil.

6.3 JEAN PIAGET (1896-1980)

Piaget is a proponent of a theory called Cognitive Development Theory. It emphasizes on the cognitive development of the child. Educators have transformed his theory into actual models and have suggested specific educational applications of Paget's work.

His theory is called constructivism. He believed that children learn by constructing their own knowledge. This knowledge is derived by understanding their environment and therefore children move from one level of understanding to another. In each stage level the constantly correct the earlier in accurate perceptions. He came up with 3 types of knowledge

- a) physical knowledge. -This is where children try to relate properties and characteristics of objects e g color, texture, size, shape, height.

- b) Social conventional Knowledge-This is knowledge transmitted through culture during interactions. e.g. moral values, language, religion.

- c) Logical mathematical knowledge-This knowledge is acquired by coordinating relationship between objects. It involves mass and volume.

Implications of piaget's theory in teaching

Sensory experiences are emphasized. According to him knowing an object requires acting upon it, transforming it, assimilating it and incorporating into operational structures. These operational structures are found in our brain. Children make errors because they are using their intelligence in their own ways.

Teachers should not correct an error but should consider how the error was made. Piaget called this cognitive development.

Young children must be active in their learning processes. The knowledge that children have acquired from previous experience should be considered when planning their lessons. Piaget therefore believed on building on previous knowledge.

Piaget presented the development in thinking ability in four periods of cognitive development. These periods are summarized as shown below.

- **Sensorimotor period (0-2 years)**

This first stage is characterized by motor behavior through coordination of senses and movement.

- **Pre-operational period (2-7 years)**

Children's internal representations develop allowing them to think of objects that are not physically present. They have an egocentric view of the world and they cannot think logically.

- **Concrete Operation period (7-11 years)**

Children are able to reverse operation. They can practice conservation (recognize that an object does not change in amount even if its physical appearance changes). They can also apply logic in solving problems and no longer depend only on what is visible.

- **Formal Operations period (11-15 years)**

It is characterized by abstract thinking and logical reasoning and it is a stage that a person can perform more complicated activities.

6.4 JOHN DEWEY (1859-1952)

Dewey developed a theory called progressivism which emphasized on the following:

- The child and his interest rather than the subject matter. Therefore, a child should choose what to do.
- Child centered curriculum and child centered schools. He emphasized that children should be involved in physical activities e.g. manipulating objects in their environments.
- Personal interaction between a teacher and children (individual attention)
- He emphasized intellectual learning, i.e. a child should be involved in problem solving.
- Respect for a child as an individual.
- Flexibility of children's program.
- Learning should be made practical by helping them learn about their environment.
- He emphasized the use of local language.
- Emphasized children's freedom with a control limit.

6.5 JOHANNE PESTALOZI (1746-1827)

His beliefs on how children should be educated.

- He believed that sensory learning like Piaget enables children to achieve their natural potentials.
- All education should be based on sensory experiences and impressions.
- Education should consider interests and capability in children
- Parents have a significant role to play in education of their children. (Jean Piaget)
- Children learn by manipulating objects and therefore adequate objects should be provided.
- Children should be exposed to exploration of their environments
- Teachers are expected to plan for children's, activities which are aimed at integrating home life and school life.

Summary of the main theoretical principles of teaching children

- Children learn through play.
- Children construct knowledge
- Children learn best when their physical needs are met and when they feel psychologically safe and secure.
- Children learn through social interaction with other adults and children.
- Children should know their interest which motivate learning
- Human development and learning are characterized by individual valuation hence each individual is unique.

ACTIVITY

1. Discuss the contributions of five modern theorists that have contributed to the growth of ECDE.
2. Compare and contrast the principles of Montessori with those of Piaget.